

Highlights

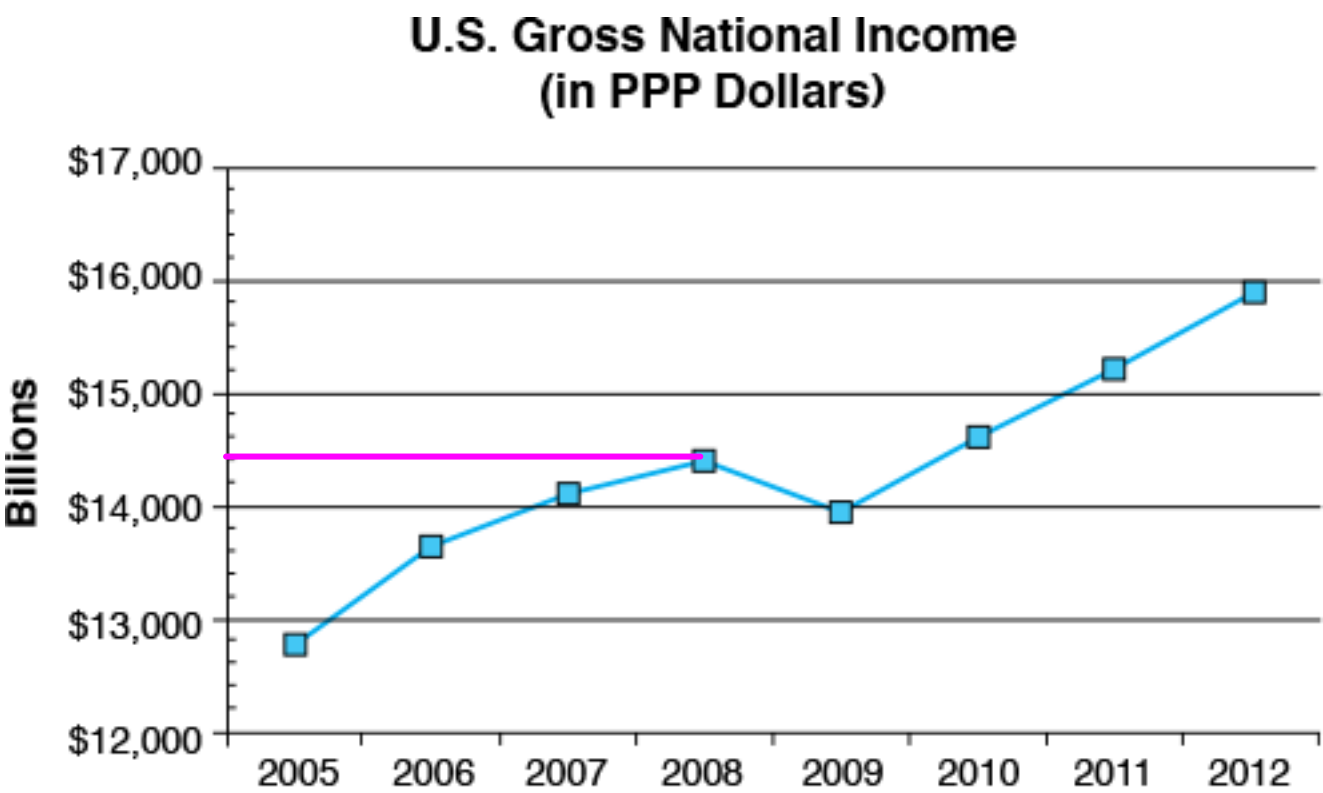
Line Graphs

Toolbox



A **line graph** is a graph that connects the plotted data points with a line. Line graphs are especially useful when showing how a quantity changes over time.

The line graph below shows the gross national income of the United States from 2005 to 2012. The gross national income is the total value of goods and services produced by a nation. The dots represent data points. From the graph, you can see that the gross national income has mostly increased over time, with only one period of decrease.



Source: World Bank

Hide

What was the *approximate* gross national income of the United States in 2008?

Step 1

Locate 2008 on the horizontal axis and find the data point directly above it.

Step 2

Read the value on the vertical axis closest to the data point.

The data point is about halfway between 14,000 and 15,000. Note that the values on the vertical axis represent billions of dollars. The gross national income in 2008 was about **\$14,500 billion**.

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Lesson 1: Graphs and Tables

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